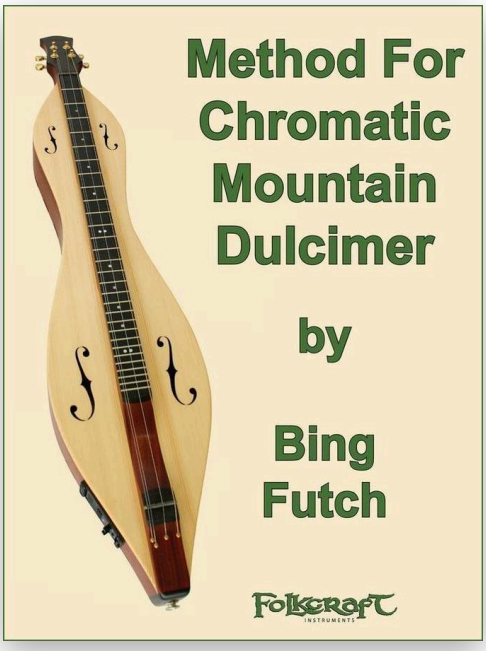
FINGERS OF STEEL® PUBLICATIONS

Method For Chromatic Mountain Dulcimer

by Bing Futch



For the chromatic mountain dulcimer, there's no other instruction book like this one. Bing Futch's Method For Chromatic Mountain Dulcimer is the definitive guide to playing it.

104 pages | Free demo audio

INSIDE THE BOOK

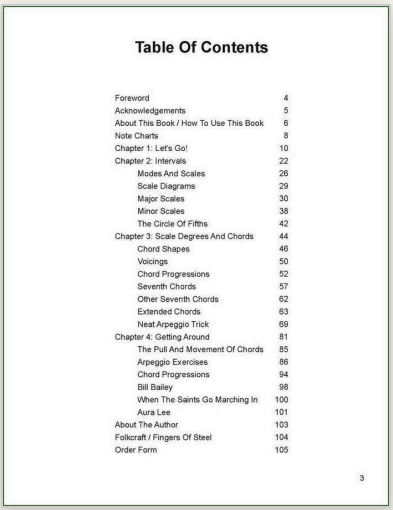
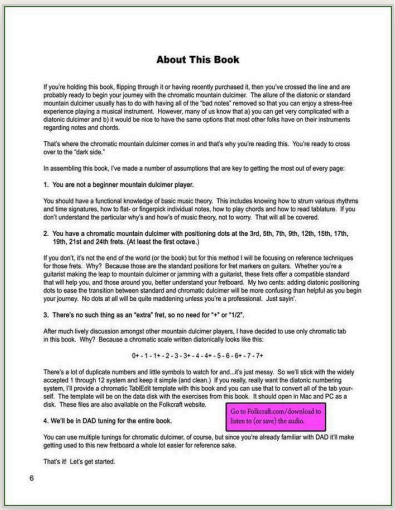


Table Of Contents

Foreword 4
Acknowledgements 5
About This Book / How To Use This Book 6
Note Charts 8
Chapter 1: Let's Go! 10
Chapter 2: Intervals 22
Modes And Scales 26
Scale Diagrams 29
Major Scales 30
Minor Scales 38
The Circle Of Fifths 42
Chapter 3: Scale Degrees And Chords 44
Chord Shapes 46
Voicings 50
Chord Progressions 52
Seventh Chords 57
Other Seventh Chords 62
Extended Chords 63
Neat Arpeggio Trick 69
Chapter 4: Getting Around 81
The Pull And Movement Of Chords 85
Arpeggio Exercises 86
Chord Progressions 94
Bill Bailey 98
When The Saints Go Marching In 100
Aura Lee 101
About The Author 103
Folkcraft / Fingers Of Steel 104
Order Form 105

3



About This Book

If you're holding this book, flipping through it or having recently purchased it, then you've crossed the line and are probably ready to begin your journey with the chromatic mountain dulcimer. The allure of the diatonic or standard mountain dulcimer usually has to do with having all of the "bad notes" removed so that you can enjoy a stress-free experience playing a musical instrument. However, many of us know that a) you can get very complicated with a diatonic dulcimer and b) it would be nice to have the same options that most other folks have on their instruments regarding notes and chords.

That's where the chromatic mountain dulcimer comes in and that's why you're reading this. You're ready to cross over to the "dark side."

In assembling this book, I've made a number of assumptions that are key to getting the most out of every page:

1. **You are not a beginner mountain dulcimer player.**

You should have a functional knowledge of basic music theory. This includes knowing how to strum various rhythms and time signatures, how to flat- or fingerpick individual notes, how to play chords and how to read tablature. If you don't understand the particular why's and how's of music theory, not to worry. That will all be covered.

2. **You have a chromatic mountain dulcimer with positioning dots at the 3rd, 5th, 7th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 17th, 19th, 21st and 24th frets. (At least the first octave.)**

If you don't, it's not the end of the world (or the book) but for this method I will be focusing on reference techniques for those frets. Why? Because those are the standard positions for fret markers on guitars. Whether you're a guitarist making the leap to mountain dulcimer or jamming with a guitarist, these frets offer a compatible standard that will help you, and those around you, better understand your fretboard. My two cents: adding diatonic positioning dots to ease the transition between standard and chromatic dulcimer will be more confusing than helpful as you begin your journey. No dots at all will be quite maddening unless you're a professional. Just sayin'.

3. **There's no such thing as an "extra" fret, so no need for "+" or "1/2".**

After much lively discussion amongst other mountain dulcimer players, I have decided to use only chromatic tab in this book. Why? Because a chromatic scale written diatonically looks like this:

0+-1-1+-2-3-3+-4-4+-5-6-6+-7-7+

There's a lot of duplicate numbers and little symbols to watch for and...it's just messy. So we'll stick with the widely accepted 1 through 12 system and keep it simple (and clean.) If you really, really want the diatonic numbering system, I'll provide a chromatic TabEdit template with this book and you can use that to convert all of the tab yourself. The template will be on the data disk with the exercises from this book. It should open in Mac and PC as a disk. These files are also available on the Folkcraft website.

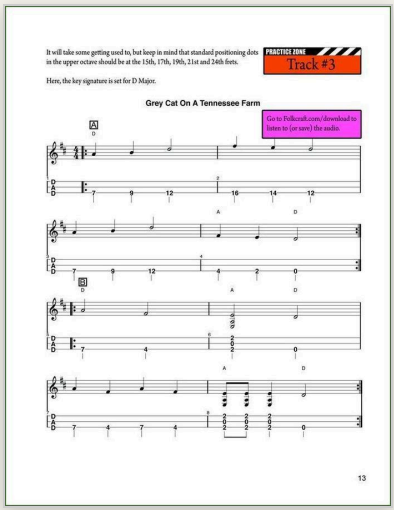
Go to Folkcraft.com / download to listen to (or save) the audio.

4. **We'll be in DAD tuning for the entire book.**

You can use multiple tunings for chromatic dulcimer, of course, but since you're already familiar with DAD it'll make getting used to this new fretboard a whole lot easier for reference sake.

That's it! Let's get started.

6



It will take some getting used to, but keep in mind that standard positioning dots in the upper octave should be at the 15th, 17th, 19th, 21st and 24th frets.

PRACTICE ZONE Track #3

Here, the key signature is set for D Major.

Grey Cat On A Tennessee Farm

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13

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ISBN 978-1-964725-01-7
Published by
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